

ANCIENT HISTORY



MODULE - 23

SANGAM AGE

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

PROTO - HISTORY

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

HISTORIC PERIOD

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

SANGAM AGE

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA

MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS



SANGAM AGE

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

WHAT DO YOU MEAN BY SANGAM?

- The word “*Sangam*” is the Tamil form of the Sanskrit word “*Sangha*” which means a group of persons or an association.
- Sangam was an *Academy of Tamil poets*.
- According to Tamil legends, there existed *three Sangams* in ancient Tamil Nadu.
- These Sangams *flourished under royal patronage of Pandyas*.

FIRST SANGAM

- Held at Madurai
- Attended by gods and legendary sages
- But no literary work was available.

SECOND SANGAM

- Held at Kapatapuram
- Attended by poets
- But all literary works had perished except *Tolkappiyam*.

THIRD SANGAM

- Held at Madurai
- Attended by a large number of poets.
- Literary works persist and preserve.

These Tamil literary works remain useful sources to reconstruct the history of the Sangam Age.

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

KINGDOMS OF SANGAM



Tamil country was ruled by three dynasties

- Chola (Northern Tamil Nadu)
- Pandya (Southern Tamil Nadu)
- Chera (Kerala region)



SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

REASONS FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF THE THREE EARLY KINGDOMS

- 1** Spreading of elements of material culture from north to south by missionary and acculturation activities.
- 2** Then the knowledge of iron-ore facilitated clearing the forest. Thus bringing land under cultivation which resulted in movement of people from uplands to plains and lead a settled life.
- 3** Due to knowledge of minting punch-marked coins facilitated trade
- 4** Trade flourished with south-east Asia and Roman empire which gave the kingdoms economic prosperity.
- 5** Monsoons was discovered by 1st C A.D, after which trade received greater impetus.

From 3rd C B.C. to 3rd A.D. is the transition period from chiefdoms to kingdoms

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SOURCES OF SANGAM AGE

ARCHEOLOGICAL SOURCES

Ashokan inscriptions

mentions Chola, Chera and Pandya

Hathigumpha inscriptions

of Kharavela of Kalinga

Excavations at

Arikkamedu, Poompuhar, Kodumanal reveals overseas commercial activity of Tamils

LITERARY SOURCES

PRIMARILY
SECULAR

SANGAM
LITERATURE

GREEK
LITERATURE

- MEGASTHENES
- PLINY
- PTOLEMY

TOILAKAPPIYAM

Earliest Tamil Literature

TOLKAPPIYAR

Tamil Grammar Book and gives information about political and socio-economic conditions

ETTUTOGAI

8 Anthologies

PATTUPATTU

10 Idylls

Both divided into

AHAM

LOVE

PURAM

VALOUR

PATHINEN KILKANAKKU

18 works, deals with ethics and morals

Most
important

TIRUKKURAL
- by Tiruvalluvar

TWO EPICS

SILAPPATHIKARAM
- Elango Adigal

MANIMEGALAI
- Sittalai Sattanar

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SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

CHOLAS



- 1 Cholas ruled over the present day northern Tamil Nadu i.e North-eastern Part of Pandya between Pennar and Velar rivers.
- 2 Their capital was first located at Uraiyur and then shifted to Puhar.
- 3 Puhar was famous port and was great center of trade and commerce and had a large dock.
- 4 Uraiyur famous for cotton trade.



SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

CHOLAS

PROMINENT KINGS



ELARA

- He was first important Chola king ruling in mid of 2nd C BC.
- He conquered Srilanka and ruled it for nearly 50 years.



KARIKALA

- He was the Greatest and most powerful of all chola rulers.
- In **Battle of Venni** he defeated confederacy of Cheras and Pandyas.
- He focussed on reviving agriculture and constructed many irrigation tanks.

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

CHOLAS

PROMINENT KINGS

KARIKALA



4 He also built **Kallanai dam** across the river Kaveri. The dam was later renovated by Sir Arthur cotton in 19th C

1 His **military achievements** made him the overlord of the whole Tamil country.

3 **Trade and commerce flourished** during his reign period.

2 He brought **forest lands under cultivation** thus adding prosperity to the people.

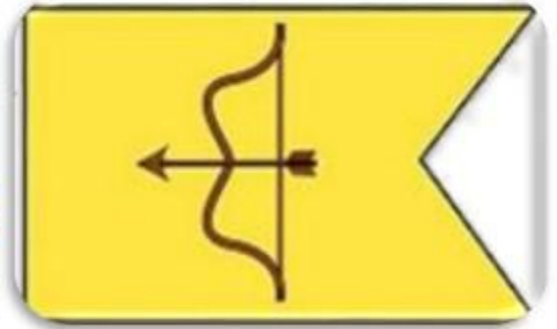
SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

CHERA



- 1 The capital of the Cheras was Vanji or Karur.
- 2 Strategically located which facilitated trade with Roman empire. Their important seaports were **Tondi and Muziri**
- 3 Cheras was the land between sea and mountains



SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

CHERA

PROMINENT KINGS



He belonged to 2nd century A.D.

After 2nd C A.D. the power declined and we know nothing of its history till 8th C A.D.



His younger brother was **Elango Adigal**, the author of ***Silappathikaram***.

Apart from his military achievements, his expedition to the Himalayas was remarkable.



He introduced **Pattini cult** or the worship of **Kannagi** as the ideal wife in Tamil Nadu.

The **stone** for making the **idol of Kannagi** was brought by him after his Himalayan expedition.

CHERAN SENGUTTUVAN

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

PANDYAS



- 1 Pandyas ruled over the present day southern Tamil Nadu.
- 2 Their capital was Madurai.
- 3 *Maduraikkanji* written by Mangudi Maruthanar describes the socio-economic condition of the Pandya country including the flourishing seaport of Korkai.

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

PANDYAS



4 Kingdom was first mentioned by **Magasthenes** in his book “Indica” where he refers

- Pandya kingdom famous for pearls
- Ruled by a women which suggest matriarchal influence.

5 They traded with roman empire and sent ambassadors to Roman empire.

6 They performed vedic sacrifices in their territories.

7 Kingdom started decline due to invasion of **Kalabhras**.

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

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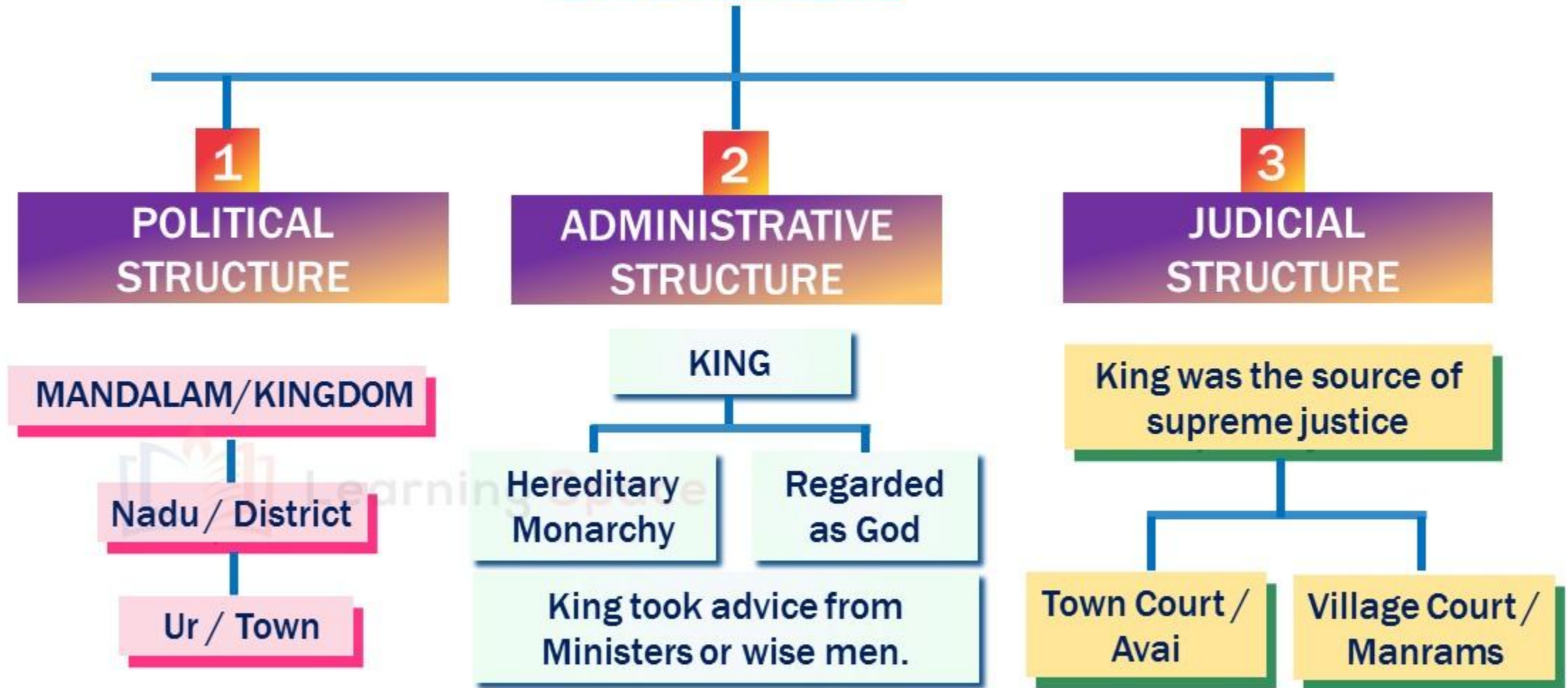
HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

SANGAM POLITY



King was known as Vandar, while the local chief were called Mannar

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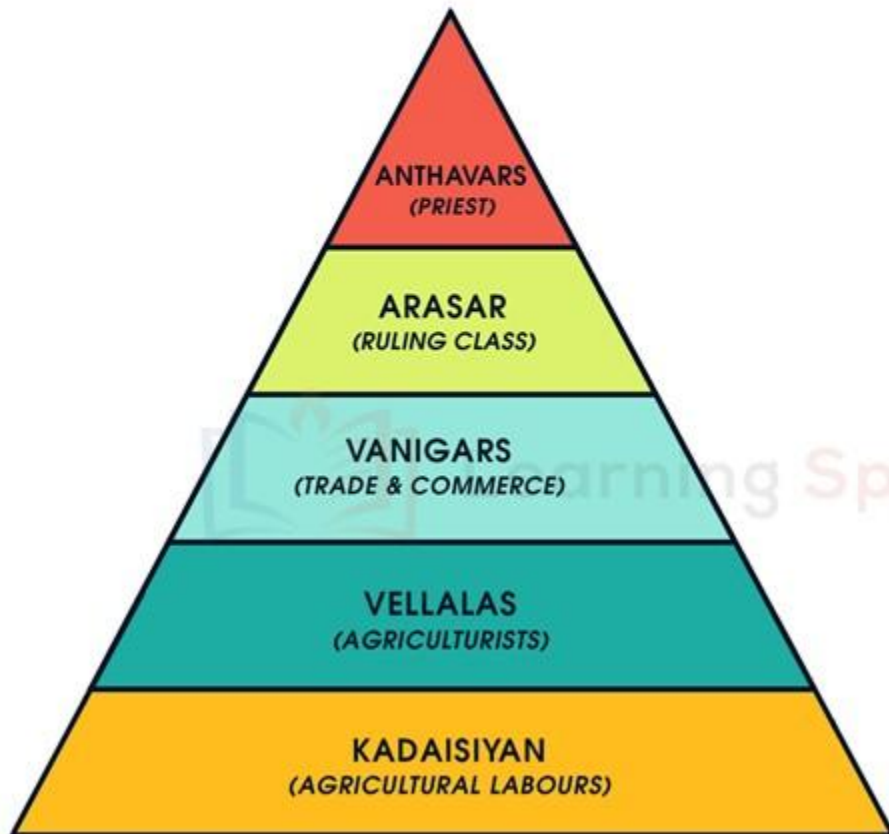
SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

SANGAM SOCIETY

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

1 SOCIAL DIVISION IN SOCIETY



1 Concept of **varna** was known to Sangam.

2 There were sharp inequalities in Sangam age. Rich were living in brick houses and wore costly cloths where as poor lived in mud huts and wore scanty cloths.

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

SANGAM SOCIETY

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

2 LAND DIVISION IN SOCIETY



KURUNJI-HILLS



PALAI-DRYLAND



MULLAI-FOREST



MARUDAM-PLAIN



NEYDAL-COAST

People living in different location had different occupation

Hunting, honey
collecting

Plunder and
cattle lifting

Shifting
agriculture

Agriculture and
animal husbandry

Fishing and salt
making

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

SANGAM SOCIETY

3

POSITION OF WOMEN

The **class of dancers** was patronized by the kings and nobles.

The **life of widows** was miserable.

Practice of Sati was also prevalent.



W
O
M
E
N

Women poets like Avvaiyar, flourished and contributed to Tamil literature.

Courage of women was appreciated in many poems.

Karpu or Chaste life was considered the highest virtue of women.

Love marriage was a common.

Women were allowed to choose their life partners



SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

SANGAM SOCIETY

4 RELIGION



MURUGAN IN THE COIN

- 1 The primary deity of the Sangam period was **Murugan**, who is hailed as Tamil God.
- 2 Brahmanas who performed religious ceremonies popularized the **worship of Indra, Vishnu and shiva** in south India.
- 3 King performed **vedic sacrifices**
- 4 There was belief in **sacred or magical forces called Ananku**. They also believed in **spiritual and philosophical truth**.

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

SANGAM SOCIETY

5 FINE ARTS



- 1 Poetry, music, Singing and dancing were popular.
- 2 Liberal donations were given to poets by the kings, chieftains and nobles.
- 3 Koothu was the most popular entertainment of the people.
- 4 Attam and koothu were performed during festivals

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SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

SANGAM ECONOMY

1 PRIMARY SECTOR



1 Agriculture was the chief occupation

2 **Common crop**

- Rice, Ragi, sugarcane, cotton, pepper, ginger, turmeric, cinnamon and a variety of fruits

3 **Chief crop**

- **Jack fruit and pepper** in the Chera country.
- **Paddy** in the Chola and Pandya country

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

SANGAM ECONOMY

2 SECONDARY SECTOR

Flourishing manufacturing industries and a high standard of living.

- 1
 - **Handicrafts** - Spinning and weaving of cotton and silk clothes. There was a great demand in the western world for the cotton clothes woven at Uraiyur
 - The poems mention the **cotton clothes** as thin as a cloud of steam.



- 2
 - Metal works
 - Carpentry
 - **Ship building** and
 - Making of ornaments using beads, stones and ivory.



SANGAM DYNASTIES

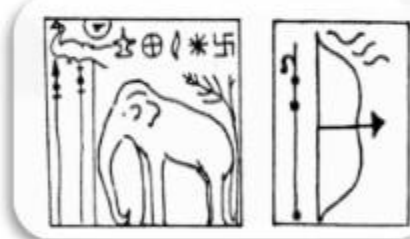
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SANGAM ECONOMY

3 TERTIARY SECTOR

COINS

These kingdoms minted their own coins with symbols depicting their state seal and plenty of gold and silver coins issued by the Roman Emperors found in all parts of Tamil Nadu.



ROMAN
COINS IN
TAMIL
KINGDOMS

TRADE

SERVICE SECTOR (TRADE)

BARTER
SYSTEM

INTERNAL

Merchants
carry goods on
carts and on
animal - back

EXTERNAL

EXPORTS

IMPORTS

MAJOR EXPORT COMMODITIES



SEMI PRECIOUS STONES



PEARLS



COTTON CLOTH



TIMBER



IVORY



SPICES

MAJOR IMPORT COMMODITIES



GOLD



HORSES



WINE

There was a great demand for these products, as the internal and external trade was at its peak during the Sangam period.

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

SANGAM ECONOMY

ECONOMIC CONDITIONS

TRADING PORTS

Trade with
Romans,
Greeks of
Egypt, Arabia

Plenty of gold
and silver coins
issued by Roman
Emperors found
in all parts of TN.



Trade with
East Asia and
Sri Lanka.

Merchants carried the goods on the carts and on animal-back from place to place where as foreign trade was carried on ships.

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

SANGAM ECONOMY

ECONOMIC CONDITIONS

SOURCE OF REVENUE

Land revenue was chief source of state's income

Custom duty was also imposed on foreign trade.

Transit duties were collected from merchants

Tribute from subordinate chiefs

Wars booty – added to royal treasure

Plunder and loot were other sources of revenue

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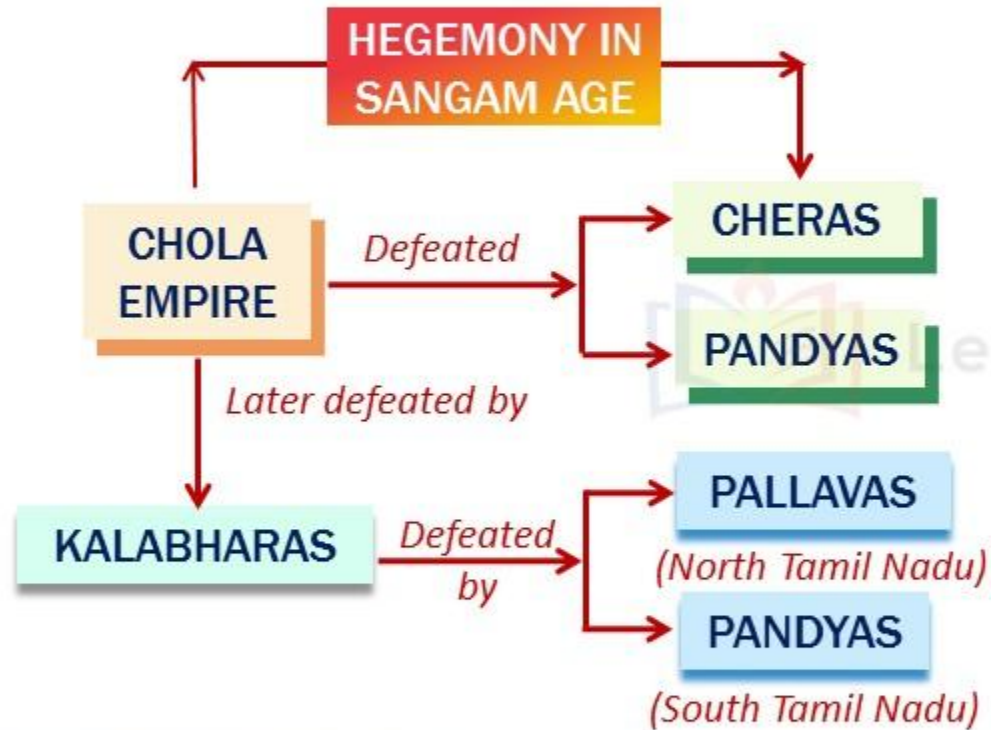
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SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

DECLINE

CHOLA HEGEMONY TILL 3rd A.D.



- Kalabhras or Kalappirars were known to have ruled the territory **between the 3rd and 7th century AD**.
- " **Kalvar**" meaning thieves.
- Later Pallavas and Pandayas drove out the Kalabharas.

A SLICE INTO THE HISTORY OF KALABHRAS

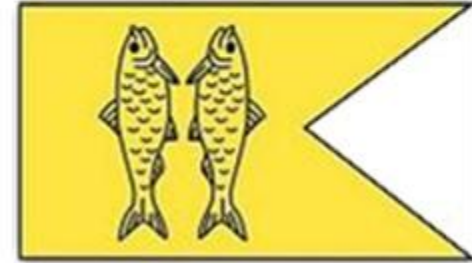
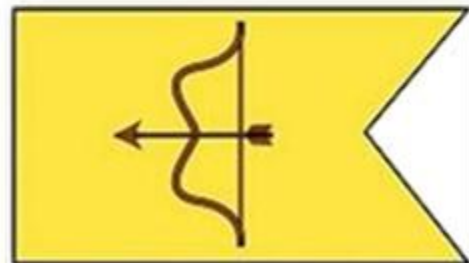
- At the end of Sangam era, Chola hegemony over Pandyas and Cheras was lost.
- **Kalabharas** were tribal clan from the **Deccan** who invaded the southern Tamil countries.
- They might be ascendants of the **Saatvahana**.
- They **did not speak Tamil**.
- Kalabhras were **patrons of Buddhism and also Jainism**.

SANGAM DYNASTIES

(3rd C BC – 3rd C AD)

THREE SOUTHERN KINGDOMS- IN SHORT

KINGDOMS	CHOLAS	CHERAS	PANDYAS
CAPITAL	URAIYUR, LATER PUHAR	VANJI OR KARUR	MADURAI
EMBLEMS	TIGER	BOW AND ARROW	CARP
FAMOUS PORTS	PUHAR (KAVERIPATTANAM)	MUZRIS, TONDI, BANDAR	KORKAI, SALIYUR



Q & A

Q.1 Assertion (A): The assemblage of literary figures was known as Sangam.

Reason (R): Tamil was the language of Sangam literature.

Codes:

- A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- B. Both A and R are true but R is not a correct explanation of A
- C. A is true but R is false
- D. Both A & R is not true

ANSWER

B

Q.2 Match the following with dynasty and royal insignia

- | | |
|-----------|----------|
| a. Chera | 1. Fish |
| b. Chola | 2. Tiger |
| c. Pandya | 3. Bow |

Code:

- | | a | b | c |
|----|---|---|---|
| A. | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| B. | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| C. | 3 | 1 | 2 |
| D. | 2 | 1 | 3 |

ANSWER

A

Q & A

Q.3 Who among the following started Kannagi worship?

- A. Nedunjelian
- B. Shenguttavan
- C. Udiyanjeral
- D. Karikal

ANSWER

B

Q.4 Match the following with social caste/class during Sangam Age

- | | |
|------------|------------------|
| a. Arasar | 1. Ruling Class |
| b. Andanar | 2. Brahman Caste |
| c. Venigar | 3. Vaishya Class |
| d. Vellar | 4. Peasant Class |

Code:

- | | a | b | c | d |
|----|---|---|---|---|
| A. | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| B. | 3 | 2 | 1 | 4 |
| C. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| D. | 4 | 1 | 3 | 2 |

ANSWER

C

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CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

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